

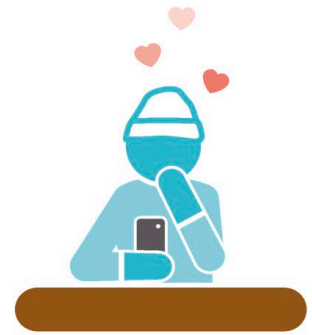
Changing emotions

For some teens, puberty brings new emotions that can be difficult to express. Teens often have periods when they feel overly sensitive, irritable, angry, self-conscious, or insecure. These feelings are completely natural, but for the teen, they can sometimes seem overwhelming. To help tweens and teens cope with the emotional side of puberty, talking to a friend or adult can provide an opportunity to reflect on new feelings.



△ Aggression

Extra testosterone can dramatically affect a teen boy's mood, and may lead to mood swings and increased aggression.



△ Romantic feelings

One exciting but confusing change at puberty is the onset of romantic feelings toward other people.



Pimples

The skin begins to produce an oily substance known as sebum, which can lead to pimples.



Wet dreams

The testicles start to produce sperm, which is released sometimes from the penis in a fluid called semen, during sleep. This is often called a "wet dream".



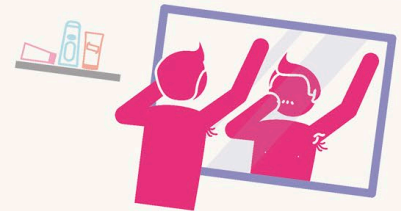
Growing bigger

Teens get taller, by up to 3.5 in (9 cm) in a year, and testosterone and other hormones cause their muscles and bones to develop.



Deeper voice

An increase in the body's testosterone levels causes the larynx (or "voice box") to enlarge and change shape. This results in the voice becoming deeper, or "breaking."



Facial and armpit hair

Soft hair starts to appear on the face and in the armpits. Many boys choose to shave off their facial hair.